Session 4

Leverage & Expansion

Ananya Narang | Founder, Entourage

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How Has Your Journey Been?

A quick reflection before we go further.

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You Could Have Posted About All of This

10 things that happened in the Indian startup ecosystem this week (Sep 28 - Oct 5, 2026):

1. Moneyview IPO listed at 61% premium on Oct 1. A fintech serving Middle India just became a public company.
2. Simple Energy raised Rs 1,750 Cr in Series C. The EV two-wheeler race just got a massive new entrant.
3. Bhavish Aggarwal pledged 4.32% of Ola Electric to fund a Rs 1,000 Cr rights issue. Founder conviction or desperation?
4. ITC completed the acquisition of Yoga Bar's parent Sproutlife Foods. A legacy FMCG giant buying a D2C brand.
5. Nikhil Kamath backed healthtech startup Aignosis with Rs 4 Cr seed round via Antler.
6. PhysicsWallah retreated from direct student lending. The edtech pivot that quietly failed.
7. Indian startups raised $233 Mn across 16 deals in one week. VC momentum is not slowing down.
8. Nykaa expects 30% revenue and GMV growth in Q2. The beauty giant is accelerating again.
9. Mayank Khanduja joined Bessemer Venture as Partner in India. A major VC talent move.
10. Razorpay partnered with OpenAI to help brands run ads on ChatGPT in India. Fintech meets AI distribution.

Every single one of these is a free distribution moment.

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Post Breakdowns: The Diagnostic

Can you answer these questions about each post that comes up?

1. **What is the one core element?**
2. **What emotion is driving it?**
3. **Where is tension created and where is it resolved?**
4. **Why did people comment?**
5. **What would have made it flop?**

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Why Outreach is the Most Underrated Skill

The biggest opportunities in your career will come from conversations you start, not applications you submit.

Kunal Shah (CRED)

Cold-messaged Sequoia's Shailendra Singh on Facebook before CRED even existed. That conversation became his first institutional backer.

Varun Dua (Acko)

Built relationships with reinsurers globally through persistent, value-first outreach for years before launching Acko. Those relationships became his moat.

Ankur Warikoo

Sent personalized LinkedIn messages to 50 founders when starting his content journey. Most replied because the message was specific, brief, and offered value first.

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Let’s think of possible ways you can meet Kunal..

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So..um let’s stick with COLD REACHOUTS?

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Proof of ability ↑

Content alone Discoverable talent Your work can travel. The right person may never see it.	**Content + outreach** Relevant, credible introduction Reach the right person. Give them a reason to engage.
Neither Invisible potential Ability stays inside your classroom and existing network.	**Outreach alone** A request from a stranger You reach their inbox. They still need evidence.

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But HOW?

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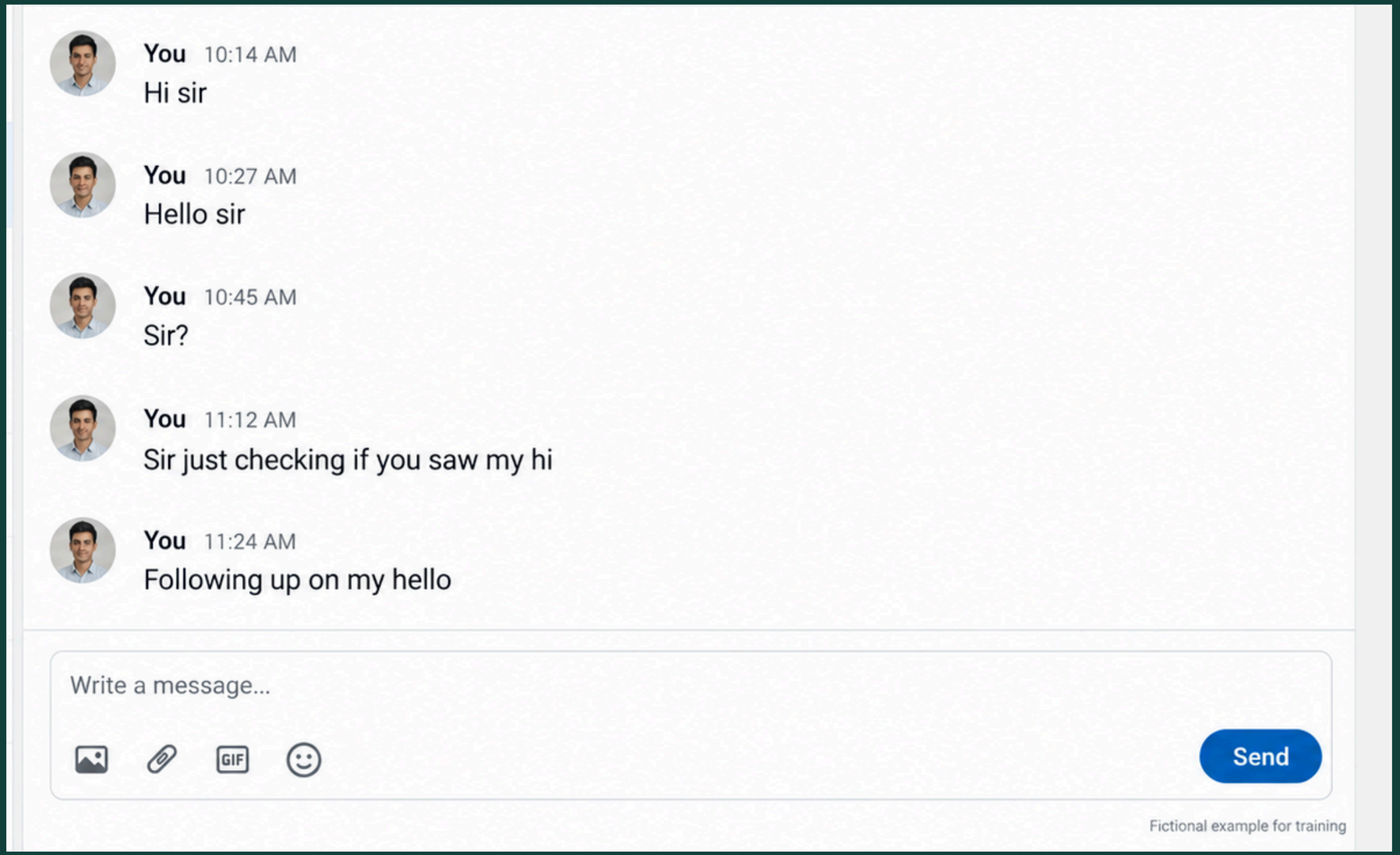

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Today

You 10:14 AM

Hi [Recipient Name],

I've been following your work at [Company Name] and really admire [specific achievement].

As a [your role/year of study], I'd love to explore opportunities in [relevant department].

I've attached my [portfolio/resume link] for your reference.

Best,
[Your Name]

Write a message...

Send

Fictional example for train

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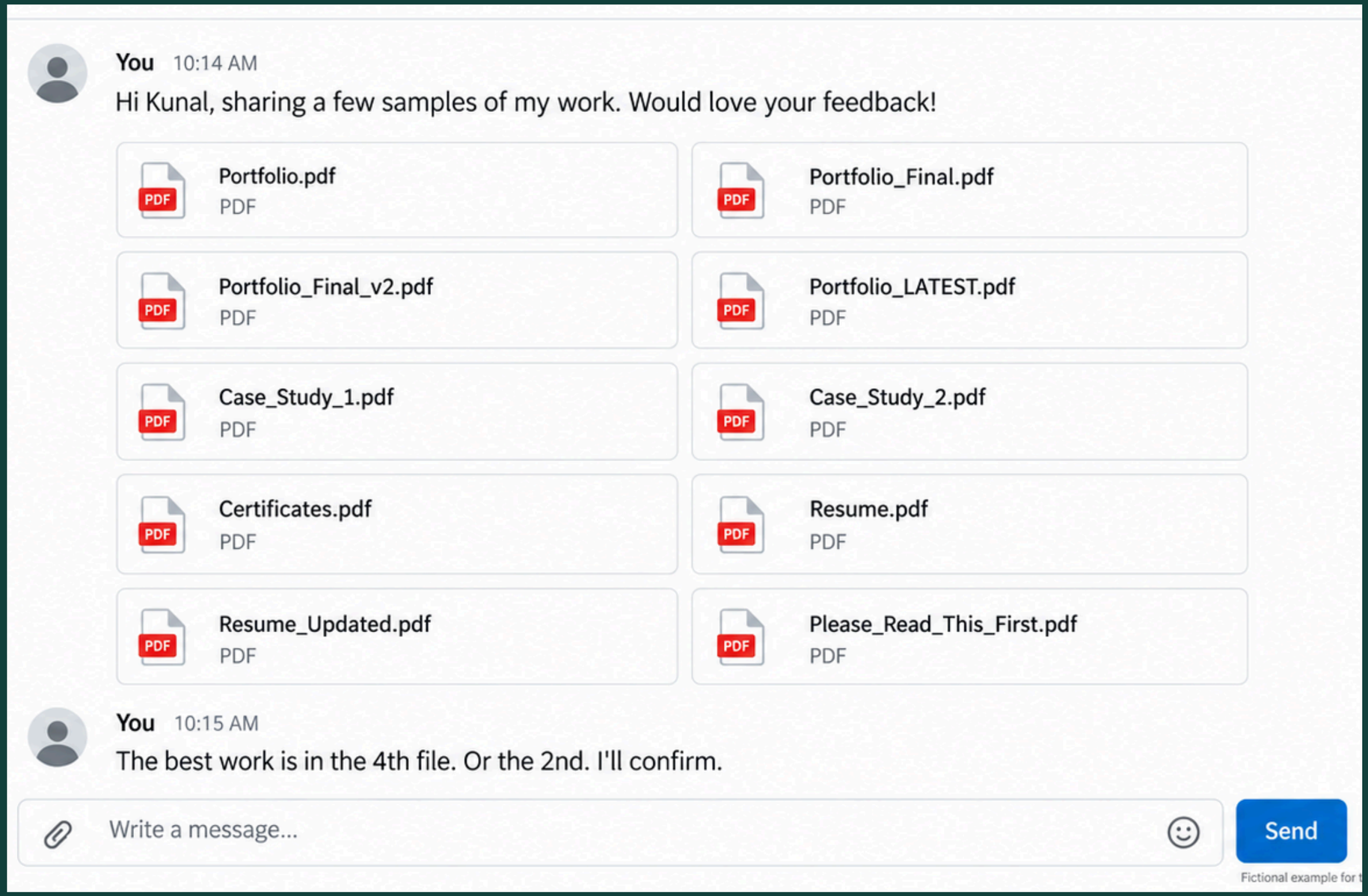

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You 10:14 AM

Hi Kunal, wanted to share my current career situation.

You 10:15 AM

You 10:16 AM

Open to internships also.

Write a message...

Send

Fictional example for training

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Reality

Stole snacks from a tourist

LinkedIn

Proactively sourced high-value food assets through direct stakeholder engagement

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Well...

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Great Outreach Templates

STUDY THESE BEFORE YOU WRITE YOUR OWN

THE VALUE-FIRST MESSAGE

"Hi [Name], I saw your post on [specific topic] and your take on [specific point] stuck with me because [why]. I'm working on [your project] at Mesa and I put together a quick teardown of [relevant thing] that I thought you might find interesting. Happy to share if useful."

THE SPECIFIC-ASK MESSAGE

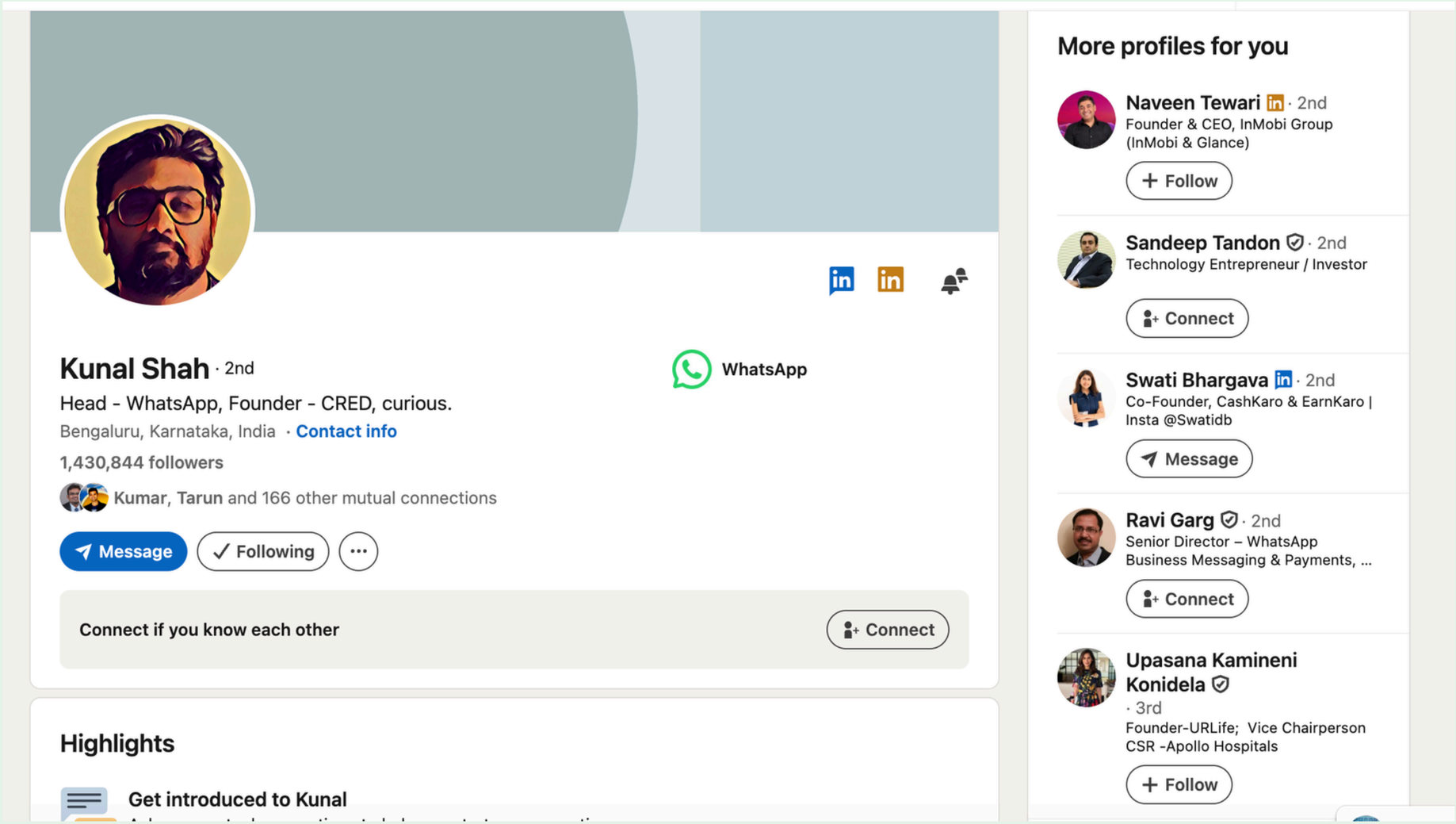
"Hi [Name], I'm [your name], a PG student at Mesa working on [domain]. Your [specific work/post/talk] on [topic] changed how I think about [what]. I have one specific question: [the question]. Would love 10 minutes of your time if you're open to it. Completely understand if not."

THE WARM FOLLOW-UP (after 2-3 weeks of engaging)

"Hi [Name], I've been following your work on [topic] for a few weeks now and left a couple of comments on your posts about [specific posts]. Your thinking on [specific insight] really resonated because I'm seeing the same pattern in my Mesa project on [project]. Would love to connect and share what I'm finding. Open to a quick 15-minute chat this week?"

Let’s reachout to 20 people!

Explore Suggested reachouts



Everything You Learned is Replicable

Instagram Reels

When your content has a visual/personality edge and your audience skews younger or founder-consumer. Face-to-camera authenticity beats production value.

Ranveer Allahbadia built an empire here. Raj Shamani's reels drove his podcast growth.

YouTube Podcasts

When your edge is depth, conversation, and access. Deepest trust of any format, compounds for years, but a heavier lift.

Nikhil Kamath's podcast and Barbershop by Shantanu became a brand in itself. WTF is Nikhil doubling down on long-form.

Newsletter

Often the best first expansion. The platform actively grows it and subscribers convert far better than followers. Your subscribers are yours forever.

Ankur Warikoo's newsletter has higher open rates than most media companies. The Morning Context proved depth wins.

Anchor LinkedIn first. Master one, then expand deliberately.

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Pick Your Next Platform

COMMIT BEFORE LEAVING

1 **Where does my audience actually spend their attention?**

If they live on LinkedIn and Twitter, that is where you expand. If they live on Instagram and YouTube, that is where you go next.

2 **Which format fits my strength?**

Speed and personality point to reels. Depth and access point to podcasts. Writing and consistency point to newsletters.

3 **Can I sustain it without diluting my LinkedIn anchor?**

If adding a platform drops your LinkedIn cadence from 3x/week to 1x/week, the expansion is costing you more than it earns.

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Friday Post: Week 4

OPTION A

The Value Post

A genuinely useful framework or 'here's how I'd approach X' designed to be saved and to make a founder think 'I want this person on my team.'

This is the post that converts attention into opportunity.

OPTION B

The Topical Take

A sharp, fast angle on a live moment in your space. A deal, a launch, a controversy everyone is already discussing.

Ride the attention that already exists with a take nobody else brought.

Pick one. Ship it this Friday.

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What You Built in 4 Weeks

This is a live asset already starting to work for you.

1	**A Positioning Engine**	Three pillars, a clear voice, and a profile that tells a stranger what you do in 8 seconds.
2	**A Content System**	The 10-minute post system, a 30-idea bank, a voice profile, and an AI co-pilot that sounds like you.
3	**A Distribution Habit**	Daily engagement, the first-4-hours protocol, and a posting cadence that compounds every week.
4	**An Outreach Playbook**	Warm outreach structure, responsibility rules, and real conversations already started.
5	**A Next-Platform Plan**	One expansion committed, one first action taken. LinkedIn stays the anchor.

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One thing to remember:

Build the asset well enough, and you stop chasing opportunity.

Opportunity starts chasing you.

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